WILLIAM ZAFARAN

Mechanical Engineer

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PROFILE

Mechanical Engineer (MSc, University of Miskolc) with hands-on CAD/CAM and manufacturing experience, and a thesis on machine learning integration for chatter prediction and its CAM implementation. Career included several years of freelance CNC/CAD work and digital design/project management roles, undertaken to support myself and my family during a period of professional disruption, before returning fully to core mechanical engineering for my master's degree. Fluent in English (C2), with a strong technical training and communication background; proficient in SolidWorks, Siemens NX, and AutoCAD, and comfortable using Python, C++, and VBA.

EDUCATION

MSc, Mechanical Engineering - University of Miskolc | *Miskolc, Hungary* | *Jul 2026*

Specialization: CAD/CAM

Final grade: 4.96 / 5.00 · ≈ 99% · ≈ 1.0, "sehr gut" (approx., modified Bavarian formula)

Thesis: "Machine Learning Integration in Chatter Prediction and Its CAM Implementation."

BSc, Mechanical Engineering - Damascus University | *Damascus, Syria* | *Dec 2023*

Specialization: Power Engineering (official transcript translation; internationally referred to as Energy Engineering)

Thesis: "Enhancing the Operational Performance of the Steam Turbine Unit at Tishreen Thermal Power Station."

German Credential Recognition (ZAB/KMK): Statement of Comparability confirms the MSc, in combination with the prior BSc, is equivalent to a German university degree at Master's level, awarded with distinction. Reg. LN2026/71244-1, 08 Sep 2026 (Zentralstelle für ausländisches Bildungswesen).

HONORS & AWARDS

- University of Miskolc - Medallion of Merit, Gold (2026).
- University of Miskolc - Medallion of Merit, Bronze (2025).
- Damascus University - Al-Basel Award for Academic Excellence (two-time recipient).

VOCATIONAL & TECHNICAL TRAINING

Hands-on technical training completed alongside my studies, developing practical/motor skills to complement the theoretical grounding of formal engineering education.

Electronics Maintenance Training - NFRD | *Damascus, Syria* | *Oct 2017 – Dec 2017*

Final grade: 87%.

Computer Maintenance Training - NFRD | *Damascus, Syria* | *Jun 2017 – Jul 2017*

Final grade: 95.5%.

AC Installation & Maintenance Training - NFRD | *Damascus, Syria* | *Jan 2016 – Mar 2016*

Final grade: 84%.

CORE ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

Master's Researcher, Mechanical Engineering - University of Miskolc | *Miskolc, Hungary* | *Sep 2025 – Present*

- Developed a data-driven software solution to optimize CNC milling stability and mitigate regenerative chatter, as part of MSc thesis research.
- Built a custom Python-based pipeline applying machine learning algorithms to evaluate complex machining dynamics and generate optimized CNC parameters.

CAD/CAM Designer - Freelance | *Aleppo, Syria* | *2017 – 2018*

- Generated production-ready G-code for 3-axis CNC milling and lathe operations for local manufacturing clients.
- Applied mechanical design principles to ensure parts were manufacturable, robust, and cost-effective under constrained resources.

Practical Session Lecturer, Industrial Electronics - Damascus University | *Damascus, Syria | Sep 2016 – Jan 2017*

- Delivered a full semester of hands-on PLC programming labs to undergraduate peers, after being entrusted by the course professor to run them independently.

Academic Peer Tutor, Mechanical Engineering | *Damascus, Syria | Sep 2014 – May 2022*

- Tutored peers in C++ programming, PLC programming, static/kinematic mechanics, and descriptive geometry throughout the degree program.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE - DESIGN, PROJECT MANAGEMENT & TECHNICAL TRAINING

Senior Digital Designer - Paylk Creative Solutions | *Remote, Dubai, UAE | May 2024 – Present*

- Delivered freelance/contract digital design work remotely while completing MSc studies in Hungary.

Project Manager - Sky Marketing | *Erbil, Iraq | Nov 2023 – Aug 2024*

- Managed cross-functional marketing projects end-to-end, coordinating design, client, and delivery teams.

Senior Graphic Designer - Sky Marketing | *Erbil, Iraq | Sep 2022 – Oct 2023*

- Produced marketing and brand design assets for client campaigns and mentored junior designers, ahead of promotion into project management.

Creative Director - Trenddxb | *Dubai, UAE | Aug 2021 – Aug 2022*

- Promoted from freelance collaborator to lead a newly established design team and launch a new regional office, on the strength of demonstrated individual output and measurable improvement in team performance.

Freelance Graphic & Presentation Design - Mauj, Hebr Design, My Slide KSA | *Damascus / Remote | 2018 – 2022*

- Delivered client design work across multiple studios, applying a technical/manufacturing mindset to visual and CNC-adjacent design projects.

PowerPoint Legend Coach - Direct Group | *Damascus, Syria | Aug 2017 – Dec 2017*

- Delivered presentation-design coaching sessions.

COMMUNITY TRAINING (VOLUNTEEERING)

Presentation Skills Coach - NFRD | *Damascus, Syria | Dec 2017 – Dec 2019*

- Designed and delivered presentation-design and software training workshops (PowerPoint and related tools).

Team Leader / Math Teacher - GOPA-DERD | *Damascus, Syria | Nov 2017 – Jan 2018*

- Led a team delivering supplementary education to displaced students in match, languages, and natural sciences.

Co-Founder / Math Teacher - Hope Compass | *Damascus, Syria | Jul 2017 – Jan 2018*

- Co-founded a community initiative delivering concentrated education to displaced students in match, languages, and natural sciences.

Life Skills Facilitator - NFRD | *Damascus, Syria | Aug 2016 – Dec 2019*

- Delivered soft-skills and life-skills training sessions based on the UNICEF Life Skills framework.

SKILLS

CAD/CAM Software: Siemens NX, SolidWorks, AutoCAD, Autodesk Inventor, Autodesk Revit, Top Solid, Vero SurfCAM

Simulation & Manufacturing Analysis: DEFORM 2D, AutoForm

Programming & Automation: Python, C++, C#, JavaScript, VBA

Business Software: SAP, Microsoft Office, Power BI

Certifications: ICDL (Standard V6, SY21000696), EF SET English Certificate (C2 Proficient)

Soft Skills: Communication & Presentation Skills, Problem-Solving, Adaptability, Resilience Under Pressure, Teamwork & Collaboration, Persuasion & Negotiation, Continuous Learning, Patience

Languages: Arabic (native), English (C2 - fluent), German (A1), French (A2), Hungarian (A1)